Data protection notice

This questionnaire collects information about your background, living situation, and experiences during hot weather. Taking part is voluntary. You can skip any question or stop at any time.

Your responses will be used only for research/project purposes. All data collected is anonymous. Do not write your name, exact address, phone number, or other information that can identify you in open-text answers.

We will store the data securely and only the project/research team will have access. We will keep the data only as long as needed for the project and then delete it.

By continuing, you confirm that you agree to take part.

This survey is anonymous.
The record of your survey responses does not contain any identifying information about you, unless a specific survey question explicitly asked for it. If you used an identifying access code to access this survey, please rest assured that this code will not be stored together with your responses. It is managed in a separate database and will only be updated to indicate whether you did (or did not) complete this survey. There is no way of matching identification access codes with survey responses.

Section 1: Demographics Profile

This section asks about your basic background.

What is your age group?

- Under 18
- 18–44
- 45–59
- 60-75
- 75 or older
- Prefer not to answer

What is your gender identity?

- Male
- Female
- Prefer to self-describe
- Prefer not to answer

What is your highest education level?

- No formal schooling
- Primary school
- High school / secondary
- Higher education (college/university)
- Prefer not to answer

Section 2: Living Conditions and Resources

This section focuses on your home and its access to basic resources during hot weather. Your answers will help us understand how living conditions affect people's ability to cope with heat.

Which of the following apply to your household (including you)? (Check all that apply)

- Children (under 18) or older adult(s) (65) live here
- Person with limited local-language skills or new to the area lives here
- Pregnant person lives here or Infant(s) (under 1 year) live here
- Someone with a chronic illness or disability lives here
- Someone with limited mobility or who needs help with daily activities lives here
- Pets live here
- None of the above
- Other

If you selected "Other", please specify (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

Which option best describes your home's heat protection and cooling?

	Well protected Air conditioning (AC)	Well protected Fans or natural ventilation	Well protected Poor ventilation (no effective cooling)	Exposed to heat Air conditioning (AC)	Exposed to heat Fans or natural ventilation	Exposed to heat Poor ventilation (no effective cooling)
Home protection	○	○	○	○	○	○

How often does your home experience interruptions to essential services (electricity and/or water)?

	Often (almost every heatwave)	Sometimes (occasionally)	Rarely	Never
Power interruptions	○	○	○	○

Which of the following resources does your household have to cope with extreme heat indoors? (Select all that apply)

- Financial capacity for major cooling investments (Can afford to purchase equipment such as AC or other cooling devices)
- Financial capacity for higher utility costs (Can afford increased electricity or water bills during heatwaves)
- Adequate home heat protection (Good insulation, shading, ventilation, or other structural heat protection)
- Support or backup resources (Backup power/water supply or financial/community assistance during heatwaves)
- None of the above
- Other

Please specify if you choose "Other" (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

Which of the following resources do you have access to outside your home during extreme heat? (Select all that apply)

- Access to air-conditioned public or commercial spaces (e.g., cooling centers, public buildings, shopping centers)
- Access to shaded or green public spaces (e.g., parks, tree cover, shaded streets)
- Access to public drinking water, cooling stations, or other basic services
- Reliable transportation to reach cooler locations when needed
- People outside my household (family, friends, community members) who can offer support during heatwaves
- None of the above
- Other

Could you describe if you choose "Other" (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

Section 3: Past Heatwave Experience & Actual Responses

This section asks about your personal experiences during past heatwaves. If you have not experienced a heatwave, please go to Section 4.
There are no right or wrong answers; we are only interested in your experiences.

In the last 5 years, have you experienced at least one heatwave where you live?

- Yes, several times (3 or more)
- Yes, once or twice
- No, never

If you have experienced more than one heatwave, please answer the next questions about one heatwave only. Choose either your most recent heatwave or the most severe heatwave you experienced.

During the hottest hours of that heatwave, how severe did the heat feel where you spent most of your time?

- Extreme (dangerously hot, normal activities not possible)
- Severe (very hot, difficult to function normally)
- Moderate (hot and uncomfortable for long periods)
- Mild (noticeably warm but manageable)
- I don’t remember

In the days just before that heatwave started, if you knew about it in advance (from any source), did you do any of the following to prepare? (Check all that apply)

- Prepared my home indoors (e.g., checked fans/AC, improved shading, ventilation, insulation)
- Stocked up on essentials (e.g., extra water, food, medicines)
- Identified or planned to use cooler outdoor places (e.g., shaded areas, cooling centers)
- Adjusted living arrangements with family (e.g., planned to stay together in a cooler home)
- Followed guidance or received support from community groups, NGOs, or public authorities
- Used specific heatwave services provided (e.g., cooling water distribution, official cooling centers)
- Did nothing
- Other

If you selected "Other", please describe what you did (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

During that heatwave, did you or someone in your household have any health problems or disabilities?

- No
- Yes, someone was already unwell (chronic illness or disability)
- Yes, someone became unwell because of the heatwave (heat-related symptoms)
- Both (already unwell and became worse or unwell due to the heatwave)

If anyone had heat-related symptoms: What actions did you take to respond to those symptoms? (Check all that apply)

- Rested at home and did basic cooling/self-care (e.g., rehydrating, taking a shower)
- Contacted a family member, neighbour or friend
- Sought medical treatment (e.g., contacted a doctor, pharmacist, clinic, or emergency services)
- Sought assistance from a community organization or NGO
- Did nothing
- Other

If you selected "Other", please describe what you did (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

During the hottest parts of that heatwave, which of the following actions did you take? (Check all that apply)

- Stayed indoors and used cooling (e.g., AC, fans, shading, closing blinds)
- Reduced physical activity or changed daily routines (e.g., avoided midday heat)
- Increased water intake and cooling practices (e.g., showers, wet cloths)
- Spent time in cooler public or shaded places (e.g., parks, cooling centers, malls)
- Stayed with or hosted family/friends in a cooler home
- Received or relied on support from community groups, NGOs, or public services
- Did nothing
- Other

If you selected "Other", please describe what you did (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity):

Section 4: Preparation, Knowledge & Potential Future Responses

This section asks about your knowledge of heat protection, how prepared you feel for future heatwaves, and what kind of support or information could help you in the future.

The next questions list different types of support that may be available during or around heatwaves (short-term, mid-term, and long-term). Some options may not exist where you live. For each category, please select the options that you think would be most helpful.

During a heatwave, which types of short-term support would you find most helpful? choose up to 3

- Clear heat alerts and official guidance on what to do
- Training or practical guidance on how I can better protect myself from heat
- Information or support to help me protect vulnerable members of my household (e.g., children, elderly, sick)
- Availability of safe, air-conditioned public spaces (e.g., cooling centers) during heatwaves
- Economic or practical assistance to support my household during extreme heat
- Opportunities to check on or support vulnerable people in my community during heatwaves

Is there any type of immediate support you would like to have during heatwaves that is currently not available or not easy to access for you? (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity)

In the weeks or months before the next heatwave, which types of support would help you better prepare? choose up to 3

- Financial support to purchase cooling equipment (e.g., fans, air conditioners)
- Guidance or tools that help me develop my own personal heat preparedness plan
- Assistance for structural home improvements that reduce indoor heat (e.g., insulation, shading, ventilation upgrades)
- Locally organized heat preparedness programs led by authorities or community organizations
- Opportunities to participate in neighborhood heat preparedness or response planning

Is there any type of mid-term support you would like to have during heatwaves that is currently not available or not easy to access for you? (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity)

Over the longer term (over the coming years), which types of changes or support would most help reduce heat-related risks in your area? choose up to 3

- Stronger building standards to ensure new housing is heat-resilient
- Incentives that support residents in making long-term heat-resilient improvements to their homes
- Long-term financial or energy assistance for vulnerable households
- Expansion of green spaces and urban tree canopy to reduce heat
- Urban design measures to reduce heat islands (e.g., shaded streets, cool materials, reflective surfaces)
- Opportunities for residents to participate in long-term heat resilience planning and decision-making

Thinking about future heatwaves, is there any other long-term support you would find helpful? (please do not include any personal data, to preserve anonymity)